

GreyNOC

Windows Privacy and Tracking Reduction Playbook

Public-facing and managed-workstation guidance for reducing optional telemetry, consumer personalization, cloud sync, AI/snapshot capture, and unnecessary app data access while preserving security updates, endpoint protection, encryption, and reliability.

Document profile	
Version	1.2 public guidance update
Date	June 12, 2026
Source reviewed	GreyNOC_Windows_Privacy_Tracking_Reduction_Playbook_v1.1_Final.docx, version 1.1, dated June 12, 2026; Microsoft privacy, Windows AI, Windows diagnostics, and Edge enterprise privacy references reviewed June 12, 2026
Primary platform	Windows 11. Windows 10 reached end of support on October 14, 2025; do not deploy unsupported Windows 10 for GreyNOC production use.
Scope	Public guidance for privacy-focused Windows 11 users, small businesses, and GreyNOC-managed Windows endpoints. Managed-device recommendations should be implemented through Intune, Group Policy, or documented local policy.

Operating principle: Reduce optional tracking and consumer personalization first. Keep Windows Update, Microsoft Defender, firewall, SmartScreen, certificate validation, and managed recovery controls working unless a qualified administrator has approved and tested an equivalent replacement.

What Was Missing From Version 1.0

The source report already covers the core Windows privacy switches: diagnostic data, tailored or personalized offers, advertising ID, activity history, location, app permissions, speech and inking, Edge privacy, Microsoft privacy dashboard cleanup, and managed-device caution. The following gaps are worth adding for GreyNOC machines:

- Windows AI and Recall:** Newer Windows 11 builds and Copilot+ PCs need explicit controls for Recall snapshots, Click to Do, Copilot, Paint AI features, and Settings AI search.

- **Cloud account exposure:** The original report does not clearly separate personal Microsoft accounts, work or school accounts, local accounts, Windows Backup, OneDrive folder backup, synced preferences, and third-party app consent.
- **Encryption key custody:** BitLocker is good security, but recovery keys should be stored in a GreyNOC-controlled account or secure vault, not a personal Microsoft account on company devices.
- **Consumer surfaces:** Start recommendations, search highlights, Widgets, Windows Spotlight, File Explorer recommendations, Store suggestions, and setup prompts can reintroduce advertising or behavioral personalization even after ad ID is disabled.
- **Delivery Optimization and network egress:** Peer-to-peer update sharing and aggressive endpoint blocking need their own guidance so privacy hardening does not break patching, Defender, certificates, or licensing.
- **Validation and exceptions:** GreyNOC needs a repeatable before/after checklist, test plan, rollback path, and exception register so hardening remains auditable.

GreyNOC stance: For company systems, manage privacy through Intune, Group Policy, or documented local policy. For personal systems, use Settings first and avoid third-party debloat tools unless the change list is reviewed and reversible.

GreyNOC Recommended Baseline

Use this baseline unless a system owner documents a business exception. The high-privacy profile is intended for research, legal, executive, incident response, travel, and sensitive-client workstations.

Area	Standard GreyNOC endpoint	High-privacy endpoint
Identity	Entra ID or managed local account. No personal Microsoft account for OS sign-in.	Managed local or Entra ID account with minimal cloud sync. Separate admin credential.
Diagnostics	Required diagnostic data only. Optional diagnostic data off. Feedback prompts off.	Required only, or Security/off where edition and support model allow it.
Personalization	Advertising ID, personalized offers, app-launch tracking, and suggested content off.	All consumer recommendations, search highlights, Widgets, and Spotlight off.
Cloud sync	OneDrive and Windows Backup only when approved. Remember my apps/preferences off by default.	No consumer OneDrive backup. Use GreyNOC-approved backup only.
AI capture	Recall unavailable or disabled. Saving snapshots off. Copilot/Click to Do only by approval.	Recall disabled and removed where supported. Click to Do and Copilot disabled.

Area	Standard GreyNOC endpoint	High-privacy endpoint
Browser	Edge or approved browser hardened. Sync and optional diagnostics off unless managed.	Strict tracking prevention after compatibility test. Extension allowlist.
Security	Defender, firewall, SmartScreen, BitLocker, Secure Boot, and updates enabled.	Same, plus stricter app control and removable-media limits if needed.
Updates	Windows Update on. Delivery Optimization LAN-only or off.	Windows Update on. No internet peer-to-peer update sharing.

Do not trade security for privacy theater: A machine with telemetry reduced but updates, Defender, SmartScreen, or certificate checks broken is less private in practice because compromise becomes more likely.

Operator Quick Runbook

Use this when preparing or reviewing a Windows workstation. Record PASS, FAIL, N/A, and exception ID.

Check	Setting path	GreyNOC target
Diagnostics	Settings > Privacy & security > Diagnostics & feedback	Optional diagnostic data Off; Delete diagnostic data; Feedback frequency Never.
Personalized offers	Diagnostics & feedback; Recommendations & offers	Personalized offers or Tailored experiences Off.
Advertising ID	Settings > Privacy & security > General	Let apps show personalized ads by using advertising ID Off.
Activity history	Settings > Privacy & security > Activity history	Store activity history Off; Clear history.
Location	Settings > Privacy & security > Location; Find my device	Off unless approved. Clear default location. Review desktop apps.
App permissions	Settings > Privacy & security > App permissions	Camera, mic, account info, contacts, calendar, diagnostics, file system: least privilege.
Speech and typing	Settings > Privacy & security > Speech / Inking & typing personalization	Online speech recognition Off unless needed; clear personal dictionary.
Cloud backup	Settings > Accounts > Windows Backup; OneDrive settings	Remember my apps/preferences Off unless managed. Folder backup only by approval.
Recall	Settings > Privacy & security > Recall & snapshots	Save snapshots Off; Delete snapshots. Apply Windows AI policy on managed devices.

Check	Setting path	GreyNOC target
Edge	edge://settings/privacy and edge://settings/profiles/sync	Optional diagnostics Off; browsing-history personalization Off; sync Off unless managed; SmartScreen On.
Search/widgets	Settings > Privacy & security > Search permissions; Personalization > Taskbar	Cloud content, search highlights, Widgets, and web suggestions Off unless needed.
Delivery Optimization	Settings > Windows Update > Advanced options > Delivery Optimization	Off or local-network only. No internet peer-to-peer sharing.
BitLocker	Settings > Privacy & security > Device encryption or Control Panel > BitLocker	On, with recovery key escrowed to GreyNOC-controlled account or vault.
Security stack	Windows Security	Defender AV, Firewall, SmartScreen, PUA protection, tamper protection, and updates On.

Identity, Account, and Cloud Data Controls

Preferred account model

- GreyNOC-owned devices should use a GreyNOC-managed identity, not a personal Microsoft account, for Windows sign-in.
- Users should run as standard users. Use a separate admin account or privileged elevation process for administrative tasks.
- Enable MFA for any Microsoft, Entra, or cloud account connected to the device.
- Remove stale devices from Microsoft or Entra device lists during offboarding.

Windows Backup, OneDrive, and sync

- Turn off Remember my apps and Remember my preferences unless GreyNOC intentionally uses Windows Backup for workstation restore.
- Do not allow consumer OneDrive to silently back up Desktop, Documents, Pictures, Music, or Videos on GreyNOC-owned systems.
- If OneDrive is required, use a GreyNOC-approved tenant and retention policy. Keep personal OneDrive accounts out of company profiles.
- If users previously used a personal Microsoft account, review the Microsoft privacy dashboard, linked devices, app permissions, and cloud-synced settings before considering the device clean.

BitLocker key custody

- Keep BitLocker or device encryption enabled. Privacy hardening must not leave local data readable after device loss or theft.
- For company devices, escrow recovery keys to Entra ID, Intune, Active Directory, or a GreyNOC-controlled secure vault.
- For standalone high-privacy devices, save the recovery key offline in a controlled vault. Do not depend on a personal Microsoft account for company recovery.
- Never enable encryption without a tested recovery-key process. Losing the key can mean losing the data.

Windows Privacy Controls

Diagnostics and feedback

- Set diagnostic data to the minimum allowed by edition and policy. For most Windows 11 Pro systems, that means Required diagnostic data only.
- Turn Optional diagnostic data Off. Then use Delete diagnostic data if available.
- Turn Personalized offers or Tailored experiences Off.
- Turn Improve inking and typing Off unless there is a documented accessibility or language-input need.
- Set Feedback frequency to Never where available.
- For managed devices, configure diagnostic data through Group Policy or MDM instead of asking users to self-police settings.

Recommendations, ads, and app launch tracking

- Turn off the Windows Advertising ID.
- Turn off website access to the language list unless needed.
- Turn off app-launch tracking used to improve Start and search results.
- Turn off suggested content in Settings, Start recommendations, account notifications, tips, and promotional setup prompts.
- Use Group Policy or Intune to disable Microsoft consumer experiences on managed systems where supported.

Activity history

- Turn Store my activity history on this device Off and clear the local history.
- Microsoft deprecated the cloud send option in Windows 11 22H2 and 23H2 after the January 23, 2024 update, but older systems may have sent activity history previously.

- Use the Microsoft privacy dashboard to delete account-linked history when a Microsoft account was used.

Location and Find My Device

- Turn Location services Off unless the user or business process needs it.
- If location is needed, allow only trusted apps and review desktop app behavior separately.
- Disable Find my device on high-privacy machines unless asset recovery is a higher priority than location minimization.
- Clear the default location when it is no longer needed.
- Remember that IP address, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, cellular, browser, and third-party app methods may still infer location outside Windows location settings.

App permissions and local sensors

- Review Camera, Microphone, Voice activation, Notifications, Account info, Contacts, Calendar, Phone calls, Call history, Email, Tasks, Messaging, Radios, Other devices, App diagnostics, Documents, Downloads, Pictures, Videos, and File system.
- Disable global categories that are unused. For shared or business devices, prefer explicit allow lists.
- Review background app permissions and startup apps. Remove apps that do not have a business purpose.
- Use external webcam covers and microphone mute controls where practical for sensitive workspaces.

Clipboard and nearby/cross-device features

- Turn Clipboard history Off if users handle secrets, incident data, credentials, or client-sensitive records.
- If Clipboard history is needed, turn Sync across devices Off unless managed and approved.
- Disable Nearby sharing and cross-device resume features unless there is a documented workflow and device-trust model.

Windows AI, Browser, and Network Controls

Recall, Click to Do, Copilot, and Windows AI

On managed commercial devices, Microsoft documents that Recall is disabled by default and users cannot enable it unless policy makes it available. GreyNOC should still enforce policy so future device changes do not surprise users.

- Check Settings > Privacy & security > Recall & snapshots on Copilot+ PCs. Turn Save snapshots Off and delete existing snapshots.
- In Group Policy or Intune, disable Allow Recall to be enabled, enable Turn off saving snapshots for use with Recall, and disable Click to Do where screenshot analysis is not approved.
- Remove or disable the Microsoft Copilot app on company devices unless approved for the role.
- Disable Settings agentic search and Paint AI features on high-privacy machines unless explicitly approved.
- For approved AI features, require written data-handling rules. Users should not paste credentials, secrets, client records, legal material, incident evidence, or regulated data into consumer AI surfaces.

Microsoft Edge and browser hardening

- Turn off Edge optional diagnostic data and browsing-history personalization unless GreyNOC has approved a managed diagnostic workflow.
- Disable browser sync for personal accounts. If sync is needed, use only a managed GreyNOC profile.
- Set tracking prevention to Strict for high-privacy profiles after compatibility testing; otherwise use Balanced with strict extension and cookie controls.
- Disable search suggestions that send typed characters to the search provider for sensitive users.
- Disable shopping, coupons, price comparison, services personalization, and similar consumer helper features.
- Use a curated extension allowlist. Remove coupon, price, search, screenshot, PDF, and shopping extensions that inspect page content unless there is a business owner.
- Keep Microsoft Defender SmartScreen and potentially unwanted app protection enabled. SmartScreen is a security feature, not optional advertising.
- Use DNS over HTTPS only with a GreyNOC-approved resolver. A private DNS service is still a third party that can observe DNS metadata.

Search, Widgets, Spotlight, and consumer experiences

- Disable search highlights, cloud content search, web results in Windows Search, and account-based content suggestions where business workflow allows.
- Turn Widgets off on workstations that do not need consumer news, weather, stocks, or personalized content.
- Replace Windows Spotlight on lock screen and desktop with a fixed local image or GreyNOC wallpaper.
- Disable Start recommendations, recently added app suggestions, tips, account notifications, and File Explorer recommendations.

- Turn off Suggested actions, device usage personalization, and post-update setup prompts that ask users to connect more Microsoft services.

Delivery Optimization and update traffic

- Keep Windows Update enabled. Do not disable patching to reduce traffic.
- Set Delivery Optimization to Off or Devices on my local network. Do not use internet peer-to-peer update sharing on GreyNOC systems.
- For managed fleets, use Intune, Windows Update for Business, WSUS, or a documented update ring strategy.
- Limit upload/download bandwidth if needed, but confirm quality updates, Defender intelligence updates, and Store app updates still work.

Network-level privacy guardrails

- Use a trusted DNS resolver or GreyNOC DNS filtering policy that blocks malware, phishing, and known trackers without breaking Microsoft security services.
- Use VPN on untrusted networks and enforce firewall profiles for Public, Private, and Domain networks.
- Avoid broad blocking of Microsoft endpoints unless deploying Microsoft's Restricted Traffic Limited Functionality Baseline in a tested Enterprise environment.
- Do not block certificate revocation, root certificate updates, Defender, Windows Update, activation, or required authentication endpoints without a signed exception.

Managed Device Policy Map

Use the table as a policy planning aid. Exact policy availability depends on Windows edition, ADMX versions, Intune templates, licensing, and update level.

Control	Preferred managed setting	Notes
Diagnostic data	Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Data Collection and Preview Builds > Allow diagnostic data = Required. MDM CSP: System/AllowTelemetry = 1.	Use Security/off only where edition supports it and monitoring/reporting impact is accepted.
Optional dumps/logs	Enable Limit dump collection and Limit diagnostic log collection.	Reduces optional error-report detail while keeping basic reliability signals.
Feedback prompts	Enable Do not show feedback notifications where available.	Prevents user survey prompts.
Recall	Windows Components > Windows AI > Allow Recall to be enabled = Disabled.	Disables the optional component and removes bits after restart where supported.

Control	Preferred managed setting	Notes
Recall snapshots	Windows Components > Windows AI > Turn off saving snapshots for use with Recall = Enabled.	Deletes existing snapshots when applied.
Click to Do	Windows Components > Windows AI > Disable Click to Do = Enabled.	Prevents screenshot analysis entry points.
Copilot app	WindowsAI CSP RemoveMicrosoftCopilotApp = Enabled where supported.	Use only after confirming approved Copilot alternatives.
Consumer content	Cloud Content and Search policies to disable consumer experiences, web search, search highlights, and personalized suggestions.	Confirm edition support before rollout.
Delivery Optimization	Delivery Optimization policy = Off or LAN-only.	Keep Windows Update and Defender update paths intact.
Edge	Configure Edge policies for SmartScreen On, optional metrics Off, sync restricted, extension allowlist, and first-run controls.	Verify at edge://policy.
App permissions	Intune Settings Catalog privacy permissions for camera, mic, location, account info, contacts, calendar, and diagnostics.	Use role-based allow lists.
BitLocker	Escrow recovery keys to Entra ID/Intune/AD. Require encryption before compliance.	Do not use personal Microsoft accounts for company key recovery.

Exception register

Each exception should name the owner, business need, data exposed, compensating controls, expiration date, and rollback path.

Exception ID	Device/user	Control changed	Reason	Review date
EX-001				
EX-002				
EX-003				

Security Controls to Keep or Strengthen

Privacy is strongest when the endpoint is resistant to malware, phishing, account theft, and physical loss. Keep the following controls on unless an approved replacement exists:

- Windows Update, Microsoft Store app updates where Store apps are used, driver/firmware updates through approved channels, and Microsoft Defender security intelligence updates.
- Microsoft Defender Antivirus, real-time protection, tamper protection, cloud-delivered protection where allowed by policy, firewall, and network protection.
- Microsoft Defender SmartScreen, reputation-based protection, and potentially unwanted app blocking.
- BitLocker or device encryption, Secure Boot, TPM, Windows Hello, and automatic lock on inactivity.
- Controlled Folder Access for high-risk users after compatibility testing.
- Least privilege: no daily-driver local admin, restricted PowerShell/script execution for standard users, and application allowlisting where practical.
- Secure disposal: wipe or reset devices before reassignment, recycle, sale, or return. Remove from Microsoft/Entra/Intune device lists after wipe.

Service-change caution: Do not randomly disable services such as Connected User Experiences and Telemetry, Windows Error Reporting, Update Orchestrator, Defender, Store, or licensing services. If GreyNOC restricts services, do it by policy, in a lab first, with rollback instructions.

Validation After Hardening

1. Reboot once after applying policy and sign in with a standard user.
2. Confirm Windows Update can check, download, and install updates.
3. Confirm Microsoft Defender updates and security scans work.
4. Confirm SmartScreen is enabled in Windows Security and Edge.
5. Open Settings privacy pages and verify optional diagnostics, offers, ad ID, activity history, and app permissions.
6. On Copilot+ PCs, verify Recall snapshots are off and existing snapshots are deleted.
7. Verify browser sync, optional diagnostics, and personalization settings per approved browser profile.
8. Confirm OneDrive/Windows Backup behavior matches the device owner decision.
9. Run gpresult or review Intune device configuration status on managed devices.
10. Capture exceptions in the register and set a review date.

Recommended user communication

Message: GreyNOC reduced optional Windows diagnostic sharing, advertising personalization, recommendations, AI snapshot capture, cloud sync, activity history, and feedback prompts where the device allowed it. Security updates, endpoint protection, encryption, firewall, and core reliability functions were left intact. Some Microsoft communication may still occur for licensing, security, updates, required diagnostics, account authentication, and approved app functionality.

Version 1.2 Additions - Public-Facing Guidance

Why this update matters

Version 1.1 already covered the major Windows privacy controls. Version 1.2 adds public-facing language, a risk-rated user profile model, safer validation checks, guidance for third-party telemetry, and clearer limits around what privacy hardening can and cannot do. These additions are intended to help GreyNOC clients make good decisions without accidentally disabling core security controls.

Public expectations and limits

- Reducing tracking does not make a device anonymous. Microsoft, the user's ISP, browser providers, app vendors, websites, extensions, DNS providers, VPN providers, and cloud services may still receive data depending on how the device is used.
- Required diagnostic data, update checks, certificate validation, activation, account sign-in, Defender intelligence updates, SmartScreen reputation checks, and other security or reliability communications may still occur.
- The goal is to reduce optional tracking, consumer personalization, advertising identifiers, unnecessary history collection, and unnecessary app access - not to break patching, security, licensing, or account recovery.
- Privacy settings should be reviewed after major Windows feature updates, new device setup, browser profile changes, Microsoft account sign-in, or installation of OEM/vendor utilities.

Risk-rated privacy profiles

- **Balanced:** Best for most home and small-business users. Turns off ad ID, personalized offers, optional diagnostics, activity history, unnecessary app permissions, and consumer suggestions. This has the lowest support risk.
- **High privacy:** Best for executives, legal, finance, travel, client data, and incident-response work. Adds strict browser settings, minimal cloud sync, Recall/snapshot controls, Widgets/Spotlight/search highlights off, least-privilege apps, and stronger account separation. Some convenience features will stop working.
- **Managed enterprise:** Best for GreyNOC or client-managed fleets. Uses Intune, Group Policy, Edge policy, BitLocker escrow, update rings, and exception tracking instead of relying on users to self-configure settings. Requires policy testing and documented rollback.

Third-party and OEM telemetry to review

- OEM utilities: Review Dell, HP, Lenovo, ASUS, Acer, Razer, NVIDIA, AMD, Intel, printer, scanner, and peripheral management tools. Disable optional analytics, experience improvement programs, targeted offers, cloud uploads, and auto-start helper apps that are not required.
- Microsoft 365 and collaboration apps: Windows privacy settings do not control every Office, Teams, Outlook, OneDrive, browser, or extension telemetry setting. Review each app's privacy, connected experiences, sync, and diagnostic options separately.
- Browser extensions: Treat extensions as applications with page access. Remove coupon, shopping, PDF, screenshot, search, grammar, and productivity extensions that can read page content unless a business owner approves them.
- Vendor agents: Remote support, RMM, EDR, backup, print management, and VPN agents may collect inventory, logs, or telemetry for legitimate administration. Keep an inventory and explain those agents separately from Windows consumer tracking.

Safe read-only validation commands

These commands help confirm posture without changing settings. Run them from PowerShell or Windows Terminal as appropriate.

- Check diagnostic policy value: `reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\DataCollection" /v AllowTelemetry`
- Check Recall or Windows AI policy keys: `reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\WindowsAI"`
- Check Delivery Optimization status: `Get-DeliveryOptimizationStatus | Select-Object FileId,Status,SourceURL,BytesFromPeers,BytesFromHttp`
- List startup apps from registry locations: `Get-CimInstance Win32_StartupCommand | Select-Object Name,Command,Location,User`
- Review local app packages for consumer apps: `Get-AppxPackage | Select-Object Name,Publisher,InstallLocation | Sort-Object Name`
- Confirm Defender status: `Get-MpComputerStatus | Select-Object AMServiceEnabled,AntivirusEnabled,RealTimeProtectionEnabled,IsTamperProtected,AntispywareSignatureLastUpdated`

What not to remove or block without approval

- Do not disable Windows Update, Update Orchestrator, Microsoft Defender, SmartScreen, firewall, certificate revocation checks, root certificate updates, activation, or authentication endpoints just to reduce network chatter.
- Do not remove BitLocker, Windows Hello, Secure Boot, TPM protections, or automatic screen lock. Device loss and credential theft are bigger privacy risks than most optional telemetry.

- Do not use random debloat scripts on client systems. Many scripts disable services without edition, update, Defender, Store, recovery, or rollback testing. If a script is used, save the change list, test in a lab, and document rollback commands.
- Do not treat Windows Event Logs, Defender alerts, EDR telemetry, backup logs, firewall logs, or asset inventory as consumer tracking. Those records often exist to prove security, investigate incidents, and recover systems.

User handoff checklist

- Explain what was changed and what was intentionally left on for security.
- Confirm whether the user wants Microsoft account sync, OneDrive folder backup, Find my device, Widgets/weather, Clipboard history, and browser sync before disabling convenience features.
- Give the user a recovery path: where BitLocker keys are stored, how backups work, how to reinstall apps, and who approves exceptions.
- Schedule a quick review after major Windows feature updates or when the user receives a new device.

Sources consulted

- Microsoft Support - Diagnostics, feedback, and privacy in Windows: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/diagnostics-feedback-and-privacy-in-windows-28808a2b-a31b-dd73-dcd3-4559a5199319>
- Microsoft Support - Privacy settings for Recommendations & offers in Windows 11: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/privacy-settings-for-recommendations-offers-in-windows-11-807608ee-3de2-4498-8e7c-eb10d655567f>
- Microsoft Support - Windows activity history and your privacy: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/windows-activity-history-and-your-privacy-2b279964-44ec-8c2f-e0c2-6779b07d2cbd>
- Microsoft Support - Windows location service and privacy: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/windows-location-service-and-privacy-3a8eee0a-5b0b-dc07-eeed-2a5ca1c49088>
- Microsoft Support - Microsoft Edge, browsing data, and privacy: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-US/edge/microsoft-edge-browsing-data-and-privacy>
- Microsoft Learn - Configure Windows diagnostic data in your organization: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/privacy/configure-windows-diagnostic-data-in-your-organization>
- Microsoft Learn - Manage connections from Windows operating system components to Microsoft services: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/privacy/manage-connections-from-windows-operating-system-components-to-microsoft-services>

- Microsoft Learn - Policy CSP - WindowsAI: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/client-management/mdm/policy-csp-windowsai>
- Microsoft Learn - Microsoft Defender SmartScreen: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/security/operating-system-security/virus-and-threat-protection/microsoft-defender-smartscreen/>
- Microsoft Support - Find your BitLocker recovery key: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/find-your-bitlocker-recovery-key-6b71ad27-0b89-ea08-f143-056f5ab347d6>
- Microsoft Privacy Statement, last updated March 2026: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/privacy/privacystatement>
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- Microsoft Learn - Configure Microsoft Edge policies to support enterprise privacy: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/deployedge/microsoft-edge-enterprise-privacy-settings>
- Microsoft Learn - Microsoft Edge Browser Policy Documentation - DiagnosticData: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/deployedge/microsoft-edge-policies/diagnosticdata>
- Microsoft Support - Windows privacy settings that apps use: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/windows-privacy-settings-that-apps-use-8b7f2cf4-c359-bf99-0f69-2123cc9ddfc1>

Disclaimer

This document is operational guidance, not legal advice. Windows settings and policy names can change. Test changes against GreyNOC applications, support needs, edition/licensing, and compliance obligations before broad deployment.